

High-chance portions — culture-lit

Combined original study articles for this topic's highest-probability PYQ themes.

Philosophy, Literature & Religion Themes

~26% · Darshanas · Literature · Bhakti literature

Schools of philosophy, classical literature and religious traditions for surprise PYQs.

Why UPSC asks this

Lower count, high surprise — breadth beats depth.

Philosophy

One-line essence of Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Samkhya, Yoga, Mimamsa, Vedanta. Avoid over-subtlety.

Literature

Author–text pairs that recur; religious literature as social history source.

Must remember

- Six astika schools overview; Charvaka/Buddhist/Jaina nastika labels in textbook framing
- Sangam, Sanskrit mahakavya, Bhakti vernaculars